

wanting to say for a long time to your boss.

You actually don't need to wait till you are sixty to get to that number. I knew a young guy once many, many years ago, who, at age twenty-eight, was convinced that all he needed was Rs 1 crore. And then what, I would ask? 'Then I will chill,' he would say.

Chill. Nice word. But unpack it a bit and you find that unless there is some purpose to your daily life, even chilling is boring. The romantic dream of having a cottage in the mountains, or by the sea, and 'pottering' about all day is – for the want of a better word – unreal.

Gosh, I would get bored in a few weeks of doing nothing. Studies show that having meaning in work ranks way above money to most people. And this is one life – why waste it in just 'chilling'? The guy is now greyer, wiser, and goes to work each day even though he does not need to.

But having enough money to retire gives you many freedoms. Freedom to choose the work you want to do, when you want to do it, and how much you want to do. I'm not talking of the super wealthy who can hire jets or zip off to watch a match abroad at a moment's notice. But regular folk like you and me. We have lifestyle expenses, but our basic middle-class background keeps a lid of most of these.

So, I'm not going to bore you with the same old arguments of how your kids won't look after you, so prepare for your own retirement. If you've been a good parent, your kids will look after you. Even if you haven't, most kids will still look after their parents.

The idea of financial freedom is to be free of any strings. Either from the boss or from your kids when you are old. This chapter is about finding out how much is enough. We know that we need a large amount of money in the future because of inflation. But exactly how big is big?

I use two rules of thumb to get to a rough estimate of how much is enough. These are rules of thumb, which mean that these are not exact numbers but a general estimate. Each person who reads this will need to bump this number up or down keeping their unique situation in mind.

The first one uses your current income which I call 'Save Your Age'. The second one – 'Multiply Your Spend' – uses your current expenditure to